Humana. Claims Payment Policy

Subject: Laboratory – Onychomycosis Testing

Application: Medicare Advantage Products
Policy number: LAB2023048
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Medicare Advantage Payment Policy

As a Medicare Advantage plan, we have developed payment policies to explain coverage more fully for services. The criteria outlined for the Commercial Payment Policy will apply to Medicare Advantage plans except when the procedure(s) has established criteria through the Original Medicare National Coverage Determinations (NCDs) and Local Coverage Determinations (LCDs) as outlined below.

In addition to this policy, claims payments are subject to other plan requirements for the processing and payment of claims, including, but not limited to, requirements of medical necessity and reasonableness and applicable referral or authorization requirements.

- For individuals with an onychomycosis *Tinea unguium* infection that is resistant to anti-fungal drug therapy, nucleic acid amplification testing (NAAT) for *Candida* (CPT code 87480*, CPT code 87481*) **IS REIMBURSABLE**.

- NAAT (CPT code 87149*, CPT code 87150*, CPT code 87153*, CPT code 87482*, CPT code 87798*, CPT code 87801*) **IS NOT REIMBURSABLE** for any of the following conditions or symptoms:
  - Disorders of the toenail, such as onycholysis, nail dystrophy, Beau's lines or yellowing of the nail
  - Onychomycosis

- For the diagnosis of onychomycosis, the use of attenuated total reflectance Fourier-transform infrared (ATR-FTIR) spectroscopy (CPT code 88749) **IS NOT REIMBURSABLE**.

- For the diagnosis of onychomycosis, testing for the presence of fungal-derived sterols (CPT code 82542) **IS NOT REIMBURSABLE**.

Applicable procedures for Medicare Advantage plans

Procedure Code	Code Description
82542	Column chromatography, includes mass spectrometry, if performed (e.g., HPLC, LC, LC/MS, LC/MS-MS, GC, GC/MS-MS, GC/MS, HPLC/MS), non-drug analyte(s) not elsewhere specified, qualitative or quantitative, each specimen
87149*	Culture, typing; identification by nucleic acid (DNA or RNA) probe, direct probe technique, per culture or isolate, each organism probed
87150*	Culture, typing; identification by nucleic acid (DNA or RNA) probe, amplified probe technique, per culture or isolate, each organism probed
87153*	Culture, typing; identification by nucleic acid sequencing method, each isolate (e.g., sequencing of the 16S rRNA gene)
87480*	Infectious agent detection by nucleic acid (DNA or RNA); *Candida* species, direct probe technique
87481*	Infectious agent detection by nucleic acid (DNA or RNA); *Candida* species, amplified probe technique
87482*	Infectious agent detection by nucleic acid (DNA or RNA); *Candida* species, quantification

Procedure Code	Code Description
87798*	Infectious agent detection by nucleic acid (DNA or RNA), not otherwise specified; amplified probe technique, each organism
87801*	Infectious agent detection by nucleic acid (DNA or RNA), multiple organisms; amplified probe(s) technique
88749	Unlisted in vivo (e.g., transcutaneous) laboratory service

Original Medicare Local Coverage Determinations (LCDs)

Contractor Name	Policy Title	Policy Number	Procedure Code
CGS Administrators, LLC	MolDX: Molecular Syndromic Panels for Infectious Disease Pathogen Identification Testing	L39038	87149 87150 87153 87480 87481 87482 87798 87801
Noridian Healthcare Solutions, LLC	MolDX: Molecular Syndromic Panels for Infectious Disease Pathogen Identification Testing	L39001	87149 87150 87153 87480 87481 87482 87798 87801
Noridian Healthcare Solutions, LLC	MolDX: Molecular Syndromic Panels for Infectious Disease Pathogen Identification Testing	L39003	87149 87150 87153 87480 87481 87482 87798 87801
Palmetto GBA	MolDX: Molecular Syndromic Panels for Infectious Disease Pathogen Identification Testing	L38988	87149 87150 87153 87480 87481 87482 87798 87801
Wisconsin Physicians Service Insurance Corporation	MolDX: Molecular Syndromic Panels for Infectious Disease Pathogen Identification Testing	L39044	87149 87150 87153 87480 87481 87482

Contractor Name	Policy Title	Policy Number	Procedure Code
			87798 87801

**The payment criterion for CPT code 87149, CPT code 87150, CPT code 87153, CPT code 87480, CPT code 87481, CPT code 87482, CPT code 87798, and CPT code 87801 applies to all Medicare jurisdictions, except those states awarded to CGS Administrators, LLC; Noridian Healthcare Solutions, LLC; Palmetto GBA; and Wisconsin Physicians Service Insurance Corporation*

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